

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8
♥ A Q 3
♦ 10 9 6 3 2
♣ 9 7

♠ Q 6 5 3

♥ 7 4 2

♦ A K

♣ Q J 5 4



♠ K 2

♥ K J 8 5

♦ J 8 7 4

♣ 10 6 3

♠ A J 7 4

♥ 10 9 6

♦ Q 5

♣ A K 8 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
♠ 10 later.			

North is to play 4 ♠. East leads the ♥ 5. The defense wins 3 ♥ tricks, then switches to a ♦.

Losers: ♠ = ? ♥ = 3 ♦ = 0 ♣ = 0 Total = 3 ?

You have already lost the 3 ♥ tricks so you must pick up the trump suit without loss. The odds aren't in your favor, but you have no choice but to play East for the doubleton King.

Lead a small ♠ from your hand and when East plays low put on the ♠ J. When this holds the trick plunk down the ♠ A and hope.

This position is one that is misplayed very often.

Look what would have occurred if you had started with the ♠ Q. East would have covered with the ♠ K (if he had it) and you would have lost a trick to the

The only hope is to try to drop the ♠ K without wasting an extra honor.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 7
 ♥ 10 5 3
 ♦ A K 10 6
 ♣ Q 6

♠ 8 6 2

♥ A Q

♦ 9 7 5 4

♣ 8 5 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 10 5 4 3

♥ 6

♦ 8 3 2

♣ K 9 7 4

♠ A

♥ K J 9 8 7 4 2

♦ Q J

♣ A J 10

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1♥
Pass	1NT	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South

When the ♣J wins you pull any leftover trumps and your hand is good.

This Deal is an excellent example of how and when to use the Double-Finesse, which gives you a 75% chance of success.

It was probably a better example of watching your entries. If you had pulled another trump before taking that first ♣ finesse you would not have been able to take the second one.

South is to play 4♥. West leads the ♦ A. The defenders take two ♦ tricks, then switch to a trump.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=2 Total = 4

The status is pretty clear, you've already lost the 2 ♦s so you have to keep your ♣ losers to just one. You have a good chance of pulling that off by playing for the ♣K and ♣Q to lie in different hands and taking two finesses.

But you will only be in dummy once more so you **MUST** make the first finesse right now. Play a small ♣ from dummy and play the ♣10. West wins with the ♣Q and plays another trump.

In dummy for the last time you must now take your second ♣ finesse. You play a small ♣ to your ♣J.